Rasoul Foroughfard

PhD Candidate, Finance

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Profile

I study empirical asset pricing, institutional demand for equities, and the role of business and financial cycles in asset markets.

Education

- Arizona State University, PhD in Finance — 2021–Present
- Sharif University of Technology, M.S. in Economics — 2017
- Persian Gulf University, B.S. in Economics — 2014

Skills

- **Quantitative Methods & Modeling:** Forecasting and Nowcasting; Static and Dynamic Factor Models; Time-Series and Panel Econometrics; Kalman Filtering and Smoothing; Dimensionality Reduction (PCA, PLS); Demand-System Modeling; Monte Carlo Simulation; Risk Modeling; Alpha Generation
- **Data:** CRSP, Compustat, WRDS, 13F, FRED, Input-Output Linkages, Bloomberg
- **Programming:** Python (pandas, statsmodels, scikit-learn); Stata
- **Computing:** AWS (EC2, S3); Linux/Unix; Cloud-based Data Processing

Professional Experience

- **Finance Research Assistant, W. P. Carey School of Business** — 2021–Present
- **Financial Market Researcher, Doniaye Eghtesad** — 2017–2020

Awards

- National Iranian Economics Olympiad, 2017 — Ranked 3rd
- National M.S. Economics Entrance Exam, 2017 — Ranked 8th

Working Papers

- **Institutional Equity Demand over Macroeconomic Cycles**
  - ▷ This paper studies how different types of institutional investors—banks, pension funds, insurers, hedge funds, and mutual funds—adjust their equity demand in response to macroeconomic conditions. I document heterogeneous responses across investor types and identify which institutions drive equity demand over the business and financial cycle.
- **Excess Institutional Demand and the Cross-Section of Stock Returns**
  - ▷ I study excess institutional demand and its relation to the cross-section of stock returns by estimating latent demand and constructing measures of demand not explained by fundamentals, and show that this excess demand strongly predicts future returns.
- **Industry Fundamentals as Leading Indicators for Equity Returns**
  - ▷ This paper constructs forward-looking signals for aggregate equity returns using real-time industry-level data. I show that changes in industry fundamentals such as employment, sales, and inventories contain predictive information for future market returns.
- **Informational Content of Institutional Demand for Industries**
  - ▷ Using 13F data, I identify institutional investors with comparative advantage across industries based on the accuracy of their historical allocations. Aggregating their signals, I construct an industry-level predictor that provides leading information for future equity returns.
- **Disagreement Among Institutional Investors and Expected Returns**
  - ▷ I measure disagreement among institutional investors using heterogeneity in equity demand and show that firms with higher disagreement earn lower subsequent returns. The results highlight the role of belief dispersion in shaping expected returns.
- **Net Buyback Dynamics and Risk**
  - ▷ Status: Revise and Resubmit, Journal of Portfolio Management
  - ▷ This paper constructs a business-cycle exposure factor using the buyback-to-dividend ratio to distinguish between transitory and persistent cash-flow components. The factor is priced in the cross-section of stock returns, linking payout dynamics to systematic risk.

Referees

- **Oliver Boguth** (Advisor), Arizona State University
  oliver.boguth@asu.edu
- **Hendrik Bessembinder**, Arizona State University
  hendrik.bessembinder@asu.edu
- **George Aragon**, Arizona State University
  george.aragon@asu.edu
- **Mazi Kazemi**, Arizona State University
  mazi.kazemi@asu.edu